ordered that the following lands be, and the same are hereby, withdrawn from settlement, location, sale, entry or other disposition and reserved for townsite purposes, and for other purposes in connection with the construction and operation of railroad lines under said Act and under such regulations as have been or may hereafter be prescribed; Provided, that nothing herein contained shall be held to preclude the use or disposition of any of the timber on said lands, in accordance with the provisions of Section 11 of the Act of Congress approved May 14, 1898 (30 Stat., 414), when it shall appear to the Secretary of the Interior or to the Alaskan Engineering Commission, that the granting of such privileges will not interfere with the purposes for which this withdrawal is made:

Description.

S½ Sec. 25; SE¼ Sec. 26, T. 20 N., R 5 E., Seward Meridian, Alaska.

WOODROW WILSON.

The White House, 26 February, 1917.

EXECUTIVE ORDER.

[No. 2539]

ALASKA TOWNSITE WITHDRAWAL NO. 14.

Under and pursuant to the provisions of the Act of Congress, approved March 12, 1914 (38 Stat., 305), entitled "An Act to authorize the President of the United States to locate, construct, and operate railroads in the Territory of Alaska, and for other purposes," it is hereby ordered that the following lands be, and the same are hereby, withdrawn from settlement, location, sale, entry, or other disposition and reserved for townsite purposes, and for other purposes in connection with the construction and operation of railroad lines under said Act and under such regulations as have been or may hereafter be prescribed; Provided, that nothing herein contained shall be held to preclude the use or disposition of any of the timber on said lands in accordance with the provisions of Sec. 11 of the Act of Congress approved May 14, 1898 (30 Stat., 114), when it shall appear to the Secretary of the Interior or to the Alaskan Engineering Commission, that the granting of such privileges will not interfere with the purposes for which this withdrawal is made:

Description.

SW¼, Sec. 31, T. 11 S. R. 7 W.

Also the following unsurveyed lands, described as Sec. 6, SW¼, Sec. 5, NW¼, Sec. 8, N½, Sec. 7, T. 12 S., R. 7 W., SE¼, Sec. 36, T. 11 S., R 8 W., and NE¼ Sec. 1, T. 12 S., R. 8 W., Fairbanks Meridian, Alaska, containing about 1760 acres.

WOODROW WILSON.

The White House, 26 February, 1917.

NEW TARIFFS ISSUED.

Supplement No. 1 to Local Passenger Tariff No. 1 has been issued, effective April 15, 1917, naming passenger fares between stations on the Anchorage Division and Eska station, located 5.5 miles north of Moose Creek.

Supplement No. 4 to Local Freight Tariff No. 5, also effective April 15, 1917, names the class rates between Anchorage and Eska, and also between Anchorage and Emery, the end of the spur line from Eska station to Martin's coal mine. Commodity rates are contained in this supplement applicable to the above two points. Freight rates between points other than Anchorage and the above two stations will be computed in accordance with Distance Tariff No. 150-A and Transportation Circular No. 56. No passenger fares are in effect to Emery.

THE COAST GUARD.

The Revenue-Cutter Service, forebear of the existing Coast Guard, has been intimately connected with and very instrumental in the development of the Territory of Alaska since its purchase from Russia in 1867. Its cutters assisted to explore the enormous coast line and make preliminary surveys of its harbors and approaches long before this Territory became a commercial asset to the United States. It carried law and order into remote parts of the new acquisition before any other branch of the Federal Government had established control of its inhabitants. It has given transportation and succor to the hardy pioneers who have blazed the way to reach the mineral, fishery, and animal resources of the Territory. Many of the earlier prospectors owe their very lives to the timely aid given them by revenue cutters.

The introduction of Siberian reindeer into northern Alaska and on the Aleutian Islands was accomplished by the Coast Guard under supervision of the Bureau of Education, and these animals are today one of the main reliances of the northern natives for food, clothing, and transportation.

The Coast Guard is charged with enforcing the international treaty relating to the seal and fur-otter herds, the fisheries regulations, and the game laws throughout the Territory.

For many years the cutters have been, and to a certain extent even at this time are, the only means of communication to the remote part of the Territory known as northern Alaska. The annual cruise of the Bear to Point Barrow is utilized to a great extent in the transportation of persons and supplies to the schools and missions along the coast. Two of the officers are always designated as United States commissioner and deputy United States marshal and transact such legal business as comes under their jurisdiction. The commanding officer in a general way settles disputes among the natives and acts in such minor cases of infraction of laws and regulations as are not necessary to be carried to the courts. In more serious cases the officer acting as commissioner takes up the matter.

The cutters patrol the waters of the Alaskan Archipelago, inspect the villages, render medical aid to the natives, and in a general way, by means of officers deputized as United States commissioners, exercise a guardianship over those inhabitants of Alaska who are far removed from the jurisdiction of the civil authorities.

Annually the United States circuit court officials of the Valdez district are taken on a cruise to the towns and villages along the Alaskan Peninsula, where court is held on board the vessel to dispose of the accumulated legal business in these remote places.

A Coast Guard station is maintained at Nome, equipped for rendering assistance to shipping in distress.

At times when epidemics have raged among the inhabitants Coast Guard cutters have been especially detailed to carry relief to the stricken people. Much assistance has also been rendered the inhabitants of Alaska by the cutters on occasions of earthquakes, volcanoes, and other calamities. In a general way the Coast Guard acts as a guardian of the Territory, and its vessels are called upon to perform all manner of miscellaneous services for the welfare of its inhabitants.